Bruce A. Desmarais — Curriculum Vitae

Department of Political Science
Pennsylvania State University
321 Pond Lab
University Park, PA 16802
Phone: (814)863-8346

bdesmarais@psu.edu
brucedesmarais.com
orcid.org/0000-0002-3031-8883
linkedin.com/in/bruce-desmarais/

Employment

Professor, Department of Political Science and Institute for Computational and Data Sciences, Pennsylvania State University. 2020–Present.

DeGrandis-McCourtney Early Career Professor in Political Science. 2018–Present.

Research Scientist, Core Data Science, Meta Platforms (Jan-Aug 2022, on sabbatical).

Associate Professor of Political Science, Pennsylvania State University. 2015–2020.

Assistant Professor of Political Science, University of Massachusetts Amherst. 2010–2015.

Affiliations

Director, Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University, Fall 2022–Present

Associate Director, Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University, Fall 2018–Spring 2022

Director of Graduate Studies, Programs in Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University, Fall 2017–Present

Education

Ph.D. Political Science, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, 2010
Specialties: Research Methods and American Politics

M.A. Political Science, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, 2008

B.A. Mathematical Economics and Public Policy, Eastern Connecticut State University, 2005, *Summa Cum Laude*

Publications

Book

1. Skyler J. Cranmer, Bruce A. Desmarais, and Jason W. Morgan. *Inferential Network Analysis*. Analytical Methods for Social Research. Cambridge University Press, 2020

Journal Articles (2021–present)

17. Taegyoon Kim, Xinyu Wang, Sarah Rajtmajer, Jeffrey J. Harden, Frederick J. Boehmke, and Bruce A. Desmarais. Elected officials' online anti-vaccination statements respond to online engagement. *Vaccine*, Accepted
16. Yuehong Cassandra Tai, Nitheesha Nakka, Sarah Rajtmajer, Kevin Munger, Yu-Ru Lin, and Bruce A. Desmarais. The digitally accountable public representation database: Online communication by u.s. officials. *Scientific Data*, 12, 2025
15. Yuehong Cassandra Tai, Yu-Ru Lin, and Bruce A. Desmarais. Elected officials' online sharing of misinformation: Institutional and ideological checks. *Political Communication*, pages 1–19, 2026
14. Sarah J. Gordon, Wayne E. Baker, Jose Uribe, Cassandra Chambers, and Bruce A. Desmarais. Networks of inclusion: Using teams and technology to create diverse social capital. *Social Networks*, 83:120–133, 2025

13. Issac Pollert, Johabed Olvera, Bruce A. Desmarais, Frederick J. Boehmke, and Jeffrey J. Harden. Collaborative diffusion: The dynamics of policy output in covid-19 interstate compacts. *Policy Studies Journal*, 53(4):944–970, 2025
12. Ishita Gopal and Bruce Desmarais. Legislative support for environmental policy innovation: an experimental test for diffusion through a cross-state policy network. *Applied Network Science*, 9(1):79, 2024
11. Rebekah Fyfe and Bruce Desmarais. Causal evidence for theories of contagious civil unrest. *International Studies Quarterly*, 68(4):sqae124, 2024
10. Ishita Gopal, Taegyoon Kim, Nitheesha Nakka, Frederick J. Boehmke, Jeffrey J. Harden, and Bruce A. Desmarais. The National Network of U.S. State Legislators on Twitter. *Political Science Research & Methods*, 13(4):1042–1054, 2024
9. Yuehong Cassandra Tai, Roan Buma, and Bruce A Desmarais. Official yet questionable: examining misinformation in us state legislators' tweets. *Journal of Information Technology & Politics*, 21(4):597–609, 2024
8. Frederick J Boehmke, Bruce A Desmarais, Abbie Eastman, Isabelle Grassel, Jeffrey J Harden, Samuel Harper, Liam Kaboli, Hyein Ko, Elisabeth Oster, and Tracee M Saunders. Sprc19: A database of state policy responses to covid-19 in the united states. *Scientific data*, 10(1):526, 2023
7. Medha Uppala and Bruce A Desmarais. Contagion, confounding, and causality: Confronting the three c's of observational political networks research. *Political Analysis*, 31(3):472–479, 2023
6. Jeffrey J Harden, Bruce A Desmarais, Mark Brockway, Frederick J Boehmke, Scott J LaCombe, Fridolin Linder, and Hanna Wallach. A diffusion network event history estimator. *The Journal of politics*, 85(2):436–452, 2023
5. Kevin L Young, Timothy Marple, James Heilman, and Bruce A Desmarais. A double-edged sword: The conditional properties of elite network ties in the financial sector. *Environment and Planning A: Economy and Space*, 55(4):997–1019, 2023
4. Sangyeon Kim, Howard Liu, and Bruce Desmarais. Spatial modeling of dyadic geopolitical interactions between moving actors. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 11(3):633–644, 2023
3. Taegyoon Kim, Nitheesha Nakka, Ishita Gopal, Bruce A Desmarais, Abigail Mancinelli, Jeffrey J Harden, Hyein Ko, and Frederick J Boehmke. Attention to the covid-19 pandemic on twitter: Partisan differences among us state legislators. *Legislative studies quarterly*, 47(4):1023–1041, 2022
2. Markus Neumann, Fridolin Linder, and Bruce Desmarais. Government websites as data: a methodological pipeline with application to the websites of municipalities in the united states. *Journal of Information Technology & Politics*, 19(4):411–422, 2022
1. Christian S Schmid, Ted Hsuan Yun Chen, and Bruce A Desmarais. Generative dynamics of supreme court citations: Analysis with a new statistical network model. *Political Analysis*, 30(4):515–534, 2022

Peer Refereed Proceedings (selected)

4. Nitheesha Nakka, Omer F. Yalcin, Bruce A. Desmarais, Sarah Rajtmajer, and Burt L. Monroe. The study of short texts in digital politics: Document aggregation for topic modeling. In *2026 IEEE International Conference on Big Data (Big Data)*, 2026. Forthcoming
3. Xinyu Wang, Emma Carpenetti, Bruce A. Desmarais, and Sarah Rajtmajer. Silence and noise: Self-censorship and opinion expression on social media. *Computer Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)*, 2026
2. Yuehong Cassandra Tai, Khushi Navin Patni, Nicholas Daniel Hemauer, Bruce Desmarais, and Yu-Ru Lin. Genai vs. human fact-checkers: Accurate ratings, flawed rationales. In *Companion Publication of the 17th ACM Web Science Conference*, pages 516–521, 2025

1. Ahana Biswas, Yu-Ru Lin, Yuehong Cassandra Tai, and Bruce A Desmarais. Political elites in the attention economy: Visibility over civility and credibility? In *19th International Conference on Web and Social Media, ICWSM 2025*, volume 19, pages 241–258. AAAI Press, 2025

Chapters in Edited Volumes

3. Ishita Gopal and Bruce Desmarais. The network science of public policy diffusion. In Dino Christenson Janet Box-Steffensmeier and Valeria Sinclair-Chapman, editors, *The Oxford Handbook of Methodological Pluralism*. Oxford University Press, 2023
2. John Schoeneman and Bruce Desmarais. Network modeling: estimation, inference, comparison, and selection. In Luigi Curini & Robert Franzese, editor, *The SAGE handbook of research methods in political science and international relations*, chapter 46, pages 876–894. SAGE Publications, London, 2020
1. Bruce A. Desmarais and Skyler J. Cranmer. Statistical inference in political networks research. In Jennifer Nicoll Victor, Alexander H. Montgomery, and Mark Lubell, editors, *The Oxford Handbook of Political Networks*. Oxford University Press, 2017

Grants

12. NSF Award Number SES-2446647. "Collaborative Research: Georelational Dynamics in Collective Action," effective 09/15/2025; $162,395.
11. NSF Award Number SES-2449569. "Collaborative Research: Belief Systems Governing Climate Adaptation Behaviors: Inference, Analysis, and Intervention," effective 06/01/2025; $148,477.
10. NSF Award Number SES-2318460. "Collaborative Research: HNDS-I: Digitally Accountable Public Representation," effective 09/01/2023; $649,380. PI with Sarah Rajtmajer and Kevin Munger, Co-PIs.
9. NSF Award Number SES- 2148215. "Collaborative Research: Patterns, Context, and Secondary Impacts of State Policy Responses to the Pandemic," effective 07/01/2022; $366,181.
8. NSF Award Number SES- 2028675. "RAPID: Collaborative Research: The Diffusion of State Policy Responses to the 2019 Novel Coronavirus," effective 05/15/2020; $16,417.
7. NSF Award Number SES-1637089. "RIDIR: Collaborative Research: DAPPR: Diffusion Analytics for Public Policy Research" effective October 1, 2016 and expires September 30, 2019. Penn State total: $142,425.
6. NSF Award Number SES-1558661. "Collaborative Research: An Expanded Framework for Inferring Public Policy Diffusion Networks." Effective June 15, 2016 and expires May 31, 2018. Penn State total: $178,953.
5. Hewlett Foundation. "Task Force Funds." effective October 15, 2015 and expires October 14, 2016. Penn State total: $77,658.
4. NSF Award Number SES-1357606. "Collaborative Research: Specification and Estimation of Exponential Family Random Graph Models for Weighted Networks." effective April 15, 2014 and expires April 14, 2015. UMass Amherst total: $29,983.
3. Russell Sage Foundation. "The Revolving Door in Financial Regulation: Elite Networks and the Consequences of Unequal Access on Policymaking." effective January 01, 2015 and expires December 31, 2015. UMass Total: $77,658.
2. NSF Award Number CISE-1320219. "Organizational Responsiveness to Open Outside Input: A Modeling Approach based on Statistical Text and Network Analysis." effective September 1, 2013 and expires August 31, 2016. Co-PI with Hanna Wallach (UMass Amherst; PI). Total: $499,326.
1. NSF Award Number SES-1360104. "Scientific Evidence in Regulation and Governance." effective May 1, 2014 and expires May 1, 2017. PI with John Hird (UMass Amherst; Co-PI). Total: $527,233.

Awards

6. 2026 Best Graduate Teaching Award, Pennsylvania State University Department of Political Science
5. 2025 Raymond Lombra Award for Distinction in the Social or Life Sciences, College of Liberal Arts, Pennsylvania State University
4. 2023 Best Book Award, honorable mention, Political Networks Section of the American Political Science Association. Awarded in recognition of *Inferential Network Analysis*, Cambridge University Press, 2021 (co-authored with Skyler Cranmer and Jason Morgan).
3. 2015 Jack Walker Award, Political Organizations and Parties Section of the American Political Science Association (with Michael Kowal and Ray La Raja).
2. Best Conference Paper on Political Networks, 2013, Political Networks Section of the American Political Science Association (with Jeffrey J. Harden and Frederick J. Boehmke).
1. Fellow for the Program on Computational Methods for the Social Sciences, Statistical and Applied Mathematical Sciences Institute, Fall 2013.

Invited Talks

Selected, 2025–2026

4. "Network Effects Panel Regression." Keynote Speaker at the opening of the Center for Network Science, University College Dublin, April 9th, 2026.
3. "Ideology, Institutions, and the Online Spread of Harmful Content by U.S. State Legislators." Computational Social Science Institute, University of Massachusetts Amherst, April 3rd, 2026.
2. "Ideology, Institutions, and the Online Spread of Harmful Content by U.S. State Legislators." Center for Language Science, Pennsylvania State University, November 4th, 2025.
1. "Public Officials' Online Sharing of Low-factual Content: Institutional and Ideological Checks" Department of Political Science, Series on AI-Assisted Data Analysis for the Study of Politics and Government, The Ohio State University, April 14th, 2025.

Teaching

Courses taught

9. Machine Learning for Political Science (Graduate: 2021, 2023)
8. Approaches and Issues in Social Data Analytics (Graduate: 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025)
7. Research Design for Social Data Analytics (Undergraduate: 2016, 2018)
6. Statistical Methods for Political Research (Graduate: 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021)
5. Political Network Analysis (Graduate: 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017, 2020, 2022, 2024)
4. Big Social Data: Approaches and Issues (Graduate: 2015, 2016, 2017)
3. Congress and the Legislative Process (Undergraduate: 2012, 2013, 2014)
2. Introduction to Quantitative Analysis (Graduate: 2012, 2014)
1. Official Secrecy in the United States, (Undergraduate: 2010, 2012)

Invited workshops (selected, 2023–2026)

5. Machine Learning for Management Research (İstanbul Bilgi University, July 2026)
4. Advanced Machine Learning (Statistical Horizons, July 2025)
3. Network Analysis in Human Subjects Research (ICPSR Summer Program, 2024 & 2025)
2. Machine Learning (Statistical Horizons, December 2023, June 2024, January 2025, June 2025)
1. Recent Advances in Network Analysis (ICPSR Summer Program, 2023)

Students Advised

Dissertation advisees

10. Nicholas Hemauer, Penn State, PhD expected 2027.
9. Nitheesha Nakka, Penn State, PhD expected 2025.
8. Ishita Gopal, Penn State, PhD awarded 2023. Current appointment: Postdoctoral Research Associate, Transdisciplinary Institute in Applied Data Sciences, Washington University in St. Louis
7. Sangyeon Kim, Penn State, PhD awarded 2023. Curent appointment: Postdoctoral Researcher, Observatory on Social Media, Indiana University.
6. Taegyoon Kim, Penn State, PhD awarded 2022. Current appointment: Assistant Professor, School of Digital Humanities and Computational Social Sciences, KAIST
5. Omer Yalcin, Penn State, PhD awarded 2021. Current appointment: Faculty Fellow, Data Analytics and Computational Social Science, University of Massachusetts Amherst
4. Ted Hsuan Yun Chen, Penn State, PhD awarded 2019. Current appointment: Assistant Professor, Department of Environmental Science and Policy, George Mason University
3. Matthew Denny, Penn State, PhD awarded 2019. Current appointment: Staff Research Scientist, Meta
2. Fridolin Linder, Penn State, PhD awarded 2018. Current appointment: Research Scientist/Software Engineer, Meta
1. Zachary Jones, Penn State, PhD awarded 2017. Current appointment: Senior Data Scientist, Amazon.

Postdoctoral Scholars Supervised

4. Isaac Pollert, 2022-2024. Current appointment: Assistant Teaching Professor of Political Science, Pennsylvania State University
3. Yuehong Cassandra Tai, 2022-2024. Current appointment: Research Assistant Professor, Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University
2. Medha Uppala, 2019-2022. Current appointment: Senior Statistician, Westat.
1. Howard Liu, 2019-2020. Current appointment: Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science, University of South Carolina.

Service

Selected external service

5. Program reviewer, Artificial Intelligence & Policy Analysis program, University at Buffalo
4. Editorial Board Member, *State Politics & Policy Quarterly*, 2020 – Present.
3. 2018–2019 President, Political Networks section of the American Political Science Association.
2. National Science Foundation Review Panel Member, Spring 2013, Summer 2014, Spring 2021, Spring 2023.
1. Reviewer: *American Political Science Review, Science, American Journal of Political Science, Political Analysis, Journal of Politics, British Journal of Political Science, Conflict Management and Peace Science International Organization, International Studies Quarterly, Proceedings of the National Academy of Science, Science, Public Administration Review, Social Networks, State Politics & Policy Quarterly, PLoS ONE, Policy Studies Journal, Political Research Quarterly, American Politics Research, Public Choice, Journal of Computational and Graphical Statistics, Journal of Machine Learning Research, Journal of Statistical Software, The Stata Journal, Journal of Public Policy*, National Science Foundation, Swiss National Science Foundation, National Science Center (Poland).